

Chapter 61 - New Year's Eve

The Qian family's bodyguards had been continuously monitoring the tracker on Qian He, so when they discovered Qian He's location had turned around and was heading back toward them, they immediately notified the captain.

"Are you sure they're heading this way?" The captain was very surprised, unable to understand what these kidnappers' purpose was.

"Yes, the tracker is moving quite fast. It should be the kidnappers' vehicle - the young lady didn't escape on her own."

The captain thought for a moment and quickly informed the police of this development. Since the police were driving marked patrol cars, they let the Qian family's cars drive in front to avoid alerting the suspects, following not far behind.

Yan Lin and the others' car was at the very back.

Qian He and the man who had kidnapped her had temporarily reached an understanding. Since they would need Qian He to speak well of them later, the man treated her relatively decently.

"Miss Qian, would you like some water? Though we only have bottled water in the car." The man reached under the seat.

Qian He glanced at him and shook her head, showing the dimples on her cheeks. "Thank you, but I'm not very thirsty."

After all, these people had still kidnapped her. Although they had seemingly reached an understanding on the surface, who knew if they had other plans brewing?

The man didn't understand Qian He's thoughts. When she refused his offer, he just pursed his lips, thinking she probably couldn't stand drinking their cheap stuff.

The van drove toward the city with its five passengers. After driving for a while, the driver seemed to see something and slowed down.

"Boss, there seem to be people ahead!" the driver shouted. The four people in back all turned to look out the windows.

Qian He looked ahead. In the distance, three cars were lined up in a row with their hazard lights flashing, and many people stood around the vehicles, blocking their path.

Because it was dark and those people were standing in front of the car headlights, Qian He couldn't make out who they were.

On the Qian family bodyguards' side, the captain stood in front of the headlights looking at the slowly approaching van in the distance, tilting his head slightly to ask, "Are you sure this is the one?"

The subordinate beside him looked at the tablet in his hands and nodded. "Yes, the tracker shows the young lady is in this vehicle."

"Did you notify the police?"

"Yes, they're flanking from both sides of the road."

The van's speed grew slower and slower, and they got closer and closer to the cars blocking the road ahead. Qian He could see more and more clearly.

When she saw her family's familiar security captain's face, the weight in her heart finally lifted. She patted the tense man's body. "Don't worry, that's my family's bodyguard. They probably came looking for me - it's fine."

Hearing this, the man finally relaxed, smiling obsequiously at Qian He. "That's good. Since it's Miss Qian's family bodyguard, we'll drop you off here."

"Mm, pull over. They won't do anything to you."

The man tapped the driver's seat back, signaling him to do as Qian He said.

The van pulled over at some distance from the people blocking the road ahead. The man reached out to open the car door for Qian He, letting her get out.

"I hope Miss Qian will keep her word."

"Don't worry." Qian He gave a harmless smile.

After getting out of the car, Qian He shouted loudly toward the convoy ahead: "Captain Zhao, it's me!"

Captain Zhao was stunned and quickly ordered his subordinates to tell the flanking police not to act rashly, then led two men forward.

Captain Zhao quickly surrounded Qian He with a human wall, then inquired about her condition.

"Miss, are you alright?"

Qian He shook her head. "I'm fine. You should call the police quickly - the people in that car are probably habitual criminals."

"The police are behind us. Don't worry."

Hearing this, Qian He finally breathed a sigh of relief. Then she pushed through the human wall, stuck her head out, and waved at the van. "You can go! We won't pursue this!"

With that, Qian He also signaled Captain Zhao to let the cars blocking the road move aside. Captain Zhao didn't know what his young lady was planning, so he actually ordered the line of cars to make way.

Seeing that Qian He had truly kept her word, the man in the van told the driver to proceed.

When passing Qian He and the others, the man even rolled down his window. "Miss Qian, you're very magnanimous. This time we wronged you - we're sorry."

"You were just doing a job. Get going quickly."

"Thank you, Miss Qian."

Watching the van pass the Qian family's convoy, the man finally breathed a sigh of relief.

Qian He was surrounded by bodyguards. After watching the van disappear, a group of plainclothes police officers emerged from all directions onto the road.

Captain Zhao introduced them to Qian He: "Miss, this is Officer Li from Beijing's Criminal Investigation Unit."

"Hello."

"Hello, Miss Qian. We'll need you to come with us to the station later to give a statement."

"Alright." Qian He nodded. "Um, I heard you have people stationed ahead too? These people should be habitual criminals - you must arrest them."

Officer Li nodded but looked ahead. "Don't worry, we have colleagues waiting for this group up front."

The man thought he had shaken off the Qian family's bodyguards and slumped back in his seat with relief.

"Damn, this time we really lost out big time. I hope that Qian girl really can handle Wang Huili, or we'll have to hide out in another province for a while."

"But fortunately, that Wang woman paid pretty well for the previous jobs, or I would have had to fall out with her!"

His subordinates quickly echoed his words.

However, before they could celebrate for long, the trembling driver called out again: "B-boss! There are cops ahead!"

Everyone's faces changed as they looked forward. The red and blue flashing police lights hurt their eyes, and there were criminal investigators pointing guns at them from in front of the vehicles, ready for action.

The van stopped in the middle of the road. The people in the car all had pale faces, only the man cursing Qian He continuously.

In the end, all four people in the van were naturally arrested by the police. Before being taken away by the authorities, the leader saw someone who shouldn't have been there.

Not far behind the police cars, a car was parked by the roadside. Standing beside the car was their original target - Feng Yue. And beside Feng Yue was none other than the Yan family's killing god - Yan Lin.

Seeing that the people had been captured, Yan Lin brought Feng Yue and the others forward.

"Have you seen them before?" Yan Lin asked, tilting her head.

Feng Yue frowned as she looked at those few people, then shook her head. "I don't recognize them. I've never seen these people."

Yan Lin nodded calmly. "Then they must be hired guns. The mastermind behind this hasn't been found yet."

Because the police were present, Yan Lin couldn't go forward to directly question those people. Fortunately, Qian He had already gotten to the bottom of this matter.

Qian He arrived belatedly with the criminal investigators behind her. The captured man became furious when he saw Qian He. "You Qian woman, you dared to deceive me!"

Qian He was surrounded by a circle of bodyguards and wasn't afraid of him at all. She snorted lightly. "What did I deceive you about? I wasn't the one who called the police. Besides, did you tell me the truth? You bunch of habitual criminals!"

Seeing Qian He, the three rushed forward. Xu Yan inquired with furrowed brows: "How are you? Are you hurt?"

Qian He smiled and shook her head, letting Xu Yan and Zhiyu examine her.

Standing to the side, Feng Yue also said apologetically: "I'm sorry. They were originally targeting me - I got you involved."

"I'm really fine. Don't blame yourself too much." Qian He smiled reassuringly at Feng Yue. Seeing that she still couldn't let it go, she joked: "If you still feel bad about it, then treat me to a meal sometime!"

Feng Yue knew Qian He was comforting her, so she smiled too. "Okay, I'll definitely treat you to a meal!"

After chatting for a while longer, Qian He remembered something important she hadn't mentioned.

"Oh right, there's one more thing." Qian He looked seriously at Feng Yue. "This whole incident was masterminded by Wang Huili. Do you have some grudge against her?"

Standing to the side, Yan Lin suddenly heard this name and took a moment to recall who it was.

Feng Yue was even more stunned. She and Wang Huili did have some conflict, but it shouldn't be enough to make the other party hire people to kidnap her!

"It should just be some minor friction between us. We had a bit of conflict at a restaurant before. You also saw what happened at the hotel today - it should just be some verbal disputes." Feng Yue couldn't understand why the other party would hire people to kidnap her.

Hearing Feng Yue's explanation, Yan Lin remembered who Wang Huili was. She narrowed her eyes, a trace of ruthlessness flashing in them. She had already warned that woman at the restaurant last time, yet she dared to target Feng Yue again.

Since that was the case, she couldn't blame her for being heartless.

Qian He went to the police station with the officers, while Xu Yan and Zhiyu were escorted home by the Qian family's bodyguards. As for Feng Yue, since those people had originally intended to kidnap her, she also had to make a trip to the police station.

And Yan Lin naturally went with her.

Since Feng Yue herself hadn't been involved in this kidnapping case, she didn't know much, and the police couldn't get much information from her. After asking her some questions, they let her go.

Yan Lin waited for her at the police station, holding a cup of hot water. Seeing Feng Yue come out, she stood up and walked forward, handing her the warm paper cup.

"Are you cold? Drink some hot water to warm up."

Feng Yue hadn't worn much. She hadn't felt cold in the hotel with the air conditioning, but after spending time at the police station, she finally felt herself shivering all over.

"Thank you." Feng Yue accepted the paper cup, warmed her hands, then tilted her head back to drink the water.

"Let's go, I'll take you home. It's already very late." Yan Lin didn't say anything else unnecessary.

Feng Yue had initially wanted to refuse, but thinking that her car had been temporarily impounded by police as evidence, and it being so late that calling a taxi would be difficult, and not wanting to contact the family driver to avoid worrying her parents, she had to follow Yan Lin.

The two walked out of the police station. Before they could open the car door, they saw the distant sky painted in colorful hues.

Feng Yue watched for a few seconds, then came to her senses and checked her phone. It was exactly midnight - they had crossed over the last stretch of the previous year.

Yan Lin was also looking up at the fireworks in the distance, then lowered her head to look at Feng Yue. The night's cold wind lifted the hair at Feng Yue's temples, like feathers falling on Yan Lin's heart, making it itch unbearably.

"Ah Yue, Happy New Year."

Hearing this, Feng Yue looked up and immediately met those eyes full of love. She felt as if she'd been stung and quickly looked away, responding indifferently: "Happy New Year."

Feng Yue said: "Let's go."

Yan Lin suppressed the disappointment in her eyes and replied with a sound.

The two got in the car without saying another word until Yan Lin stopped the car in front of Feng Yue's house. They hadn't spoken a single sentence to each other.

"Thank you for taking me home."

"Mm."

With that, Feng Yue pushed open the car door and got out. Yan Lin watched her retreating figure and finally couldn't help but get out of the car to call after Feng Yue.

"Ah Yue!" Yan Lin called out.

The entire villa district was very quiet. Hearing this, Feng Yue stopped but didn't turn around, just standing with her back to her.

Yan Lin didn't walk forward but stood by the car, giving them some space and distance.

"Heaven gave me a chance to start over, so I have no choice but to pursue my moon. I won't repeat the mistakes of my previous life. I'll change everything you don't like, so I hope you can give me a chance - a chance to pay for my previous life's mistakes and let me make amends to you properly."

Feng Yue stood in place, quietly listening to everything she said. Strangely, she felt no other emotions. She was very calm, calmly thinking about Yan Lin's purpose in saying these things.

Seeing that Feng Yue had no response at all, Yan Lin pressed her lips together and clenched her sleeves. She knew her past self had been too wrong, so she didn't expect Feng Yue to respond to her immediately.

No response was also a kind of response.

Yan Lin slowly exhaled and said gently: "It's too cold outside. Go home quickly. Happy New Year, good night."

Feng Yue stirred. "Happy New Year, drive safely." With that, she went home without looking back.

Yan Lin watched the door open and close in front of her, feeling heartbroken for two seconds. Then she returned to the car, took out the New Year's gift that Feng Yue had refused, and placed it at Feng Yue's front door.

"I hope you'll like it."

In the new year, some people might be able to start fresh, but others were destined to have bad luck from the very beginning.

Not long after Yan Lin left, several police cars drove into the villa district and knocked on the door of the villa next to Feng Yue's house.

The housekeeper auntie, wearing a coat and sleepy-eyed, opened the door to see a group of police officers surrounding the entrance.

"Hello, we're from Beijing's Criminal Investigation Unit. This is my police ID. We suspect Wang Huili is involved in a kidnapping case. Please come with us to the station to cooperate with our investigation."